

COGNITIVE BEHAVIORAL THERAPY (CBT) – SESSION 6

Consolidating Progress & Introducing Worry Postponement

Fictional Educational Example — Full Detailed

SESSION INFORMATION

Client:	RK (35 y/o Male)	Therapist:	Dr. A.
Session #:	6 of 16	Focus:	Review + Worry Postponement + Consolidation

PRE-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

Client continuing to make steady progress. Belief in the old perfectionistic thought is now around 35%. Behavioral experiments have been successful. Today we will review all homework, introduce formal ****Worry Postponement**** (building on Worry Time), consolidate cognitive gains, and plan for the second half of therapy.

SESSION START & HOMEWORK REVIEW

Therapist: Good morning, RK. How has your week been? Let's review the homework together.

Client: It was a good week. Worry Time is helping a lot. I'm postponing worries more naturally now. The experiments are also making me feel more confident at work.

Therapist: That's wonderful to hear. Can you tell me about one of the experiments you tried this week?

Client: I shared an idea in a meeting without over-preparing it. It went well. No one questioned my competence. I felt anxious before, but much calmer after.

Therapist: Excellent. These real-life experiments are very powerful because they give you direct evidence against the old belief.

INTRODUCING WORRY POSTPONEMENT

Therapist: Last session we introduced Worry Time. Today I'd like to build on that with a technique called ****Worry Postponement****. It's similar but more flexible. When a worry comes up during the day, instead of engaging with it immediately, you write it down briefly and tell yourself: "I'll deal with this later during my Worry Time." This helps train your brain to delay worry rather than suppress it.

Client: I think I've already been doing something similar without realizing it. It feels less exhausting than trying to fight the worry all day.

Therapist: That's perfect. The goal is not to eliminate worry completely (that's impossible), but to reduce how much it interferes with your day and your sleep. Many people find that after a few weeks of consistent practice, the urge to worry during the day naturally decreases.

CONSOLIDATING COGNITIVE GAINS

Therapist: Let's take a moment to review how much your thinking has changed since we started. When we began, the belief "I have to be perfect or they will see I'm not good enough" was at about 80%. Where is it now?

Client: Around 35%. And on good days it feels even lower.

Therapist: That's a very significant shift. What evidence from the last few weeks has helped reduce it the most?

Client: The behavioral experiments — especially when I deliberately didn't over-prepare and things still went fine. Also, the historical review helped me understand where the belief came from and that it's an old rule that doesn't fit my life anymore.

Therapist: Those are powerful insights. The combination of experiments (behavioral) and understanding the origin of the belief (cognitive) is often what creates lasting change.

HOMEWORK ASSIGNMENT

Therapist: For this week:

1. Continue daily diary + Worry Time / Worry Postponement practice
2. Keep using the new balanced belief and rate your belief in the old one daily
3. Do one more behavioral experiment related to imperfection or setting a boundary
4. Write down 3 pieces of evidence from the last 2 weeks that support your new belief ("I can be good enough without being perfect")

SESSION SUMMARY & FEEDBACK

Therapist: Today we reviewed your successful experiments, introduced Worry Postponement, and consolidated how much your core belief has changed. What felt most useful?

Client: Seeing how much the belief has dropped from 80% to 35% was motivating. And Worry Postponement feels like a natural next step from Worry Time.

Therapist: Great. Any questions before we finish?

Client: No, everything is clear.

POST-SESSION THERAPIST NOTES

- Strong consolidation of cognitive and behavioral gains.
- Core belief significantly reduced (80% → 35%).
- Worry Postponement introduced and well received.
- Client showing good self-efficacy and motivation.
- Next session: Review consolidated evidence, continue behavioral experiments, begin preparing for mid-therapy review and planning for the second half of treatment.

Disclaimer: This is a completely fictional but realistic simulation created solely for educational and AI training purposes. It does not represent any real person or therapy.